

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

## AI for Workload: Winning Back an Hour a Week

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session: every teacher audits their real week, templates their two worst repeating tasks, and writes a protected list of the work that stays human. Run by your own coach; no consultant required.

### THE STANCE, AND YOUR STAFF ANSWER

Hand the repetitive to the tool; keep the relational on purpose. Recovered hours go to teaching, planning, or leaving on time, never to new busywork.

### Why this matters now

In Gallup's February 2022 workforce survey, K-12 reported the highest burnout of the industries measured: 44% of workers and 52% of teachers "always or very often" burned out (Gallup, 2022), inside a ~54-hour week where less than half is teaching (Merrimack/EdWeek, 2022). Teachers using AI weekly report ~5.9 hours a week back, about six weeks a year (Gallup, 2025). This session locates each teacher's share of those hours, and writes down what the hours are for.

### What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Audit a week with the two-question sort: needs my kids? does it repeat?
- Template recurring tasks: build once with placeholders, test twice, reuse forever
- Batch same-kind tasks and share templates in the staff library
- Keep a written protected list: the relational work no tool touches
- Hold the review rule so "AI drafts it" never drifts into "AI decides it"
- Keep the privacy rule: no student information in public tools, at any workload

### Research base in brief

Burnout: Gallup Panel Workforce Study (2022) · Teacher workweek: Merrimack College & EdWeek Research Center (2022) · Time savings: Gallup & Walton Family Foundation (2025) · Adoption: RAND RR-A4180-1 (2025) · PD design: Darling-Hammond et al., Learning Policy Institute (2017). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

### Where it fits

Kit 7 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**. Ships with a 30-day plan (template clinic, library sprint, and an honest reckoning on where the hours went) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Kit 8, the capstone, is next.

**The leadership move that makes it real:** say publicly that recovered hours will not be refilled with new initiatives. It costs nothing, and it's the highest-trust sentence available to a school leader this month.